

Alexander Chaika

manti.by@gmail.com / <https://github.com/manti-by>

Software Engineer

AI-first Python backend engineer with 17+ years of experience designing and operating high-availability systems in fintech, medtech, ad-tech, and data-intensive domains. Deep expertise in distributed architectures, AWS cloud, and data platforms. Focus on AI-enabled and AI-native services including agentic workflows, RAG, vector search, and LLM integrations. Proven track record delivering scalable APIs, improving system reliability, and driving performance optimization in production.

Professional Experience

Core competencies: Python, Django/FastAPI, PostgreSQL, AWS.

Languages: Python, SQL, JavaScript, HTML/CSS, Bash, Rust, PHP, C++, Ruby.

AI: LangChain, OpenRouter, LlamaIndex, RAG, HuggingFace, Claude, OpenCode, Perplexity.

Frameworks and technologies: DRF, Asyncio/Aiohttp, FastAPI, Falcon, SQLAlchemy, Celery/RQ, Pandas/NumPy/OpenCV.

Databases: PostgreSQL, Redis, Elasticsearch, MongoDB, Snowflake, Neo4j.

Distributed systems: Kafka, RabbitMQ, Airflow, ETL pipelines.

Third-party APIs: Stripe, Plaid, Authorize.net, LeanPlum, Salesforce, Solana, Equifax, Trolley/Unit/Passport, Mandrill/Mailchimp/Mailgun.

Cloud and DevOps: AWS (ECS, RDS, S3, Lambda, API Gateway, SQS, SNS, WAF), Docker, Terraform/CDK, GitHub Actions.

Management and Modeling Tools: Linear, JIRA, Miro, Figma.

Practices: System design, performance tuning, observability, secure SDLC.

Education

Master of Computer Applications - Polotsk State University, 2008.

Associate Degree, Economics - Moscow Modern University for the Humanities, 2011.

Hobbies

Electronics, architecture, music production, photo.

Major projects

Lead Software Engineer - Suvoda (MedTech, US)

From Nov 2025 | Python, Falcon, PostgreSQL, AWS, AI SDLC

- Delivery for core product areas, designing and implementing backend services and front-end features that support patient payments, randomization, and trial operations.
- Own key parts of the microservice architecture, improving scalability, observability, and deployment automation for regulated production workloads.
- Drive Developer Experience initiatives: refine CI/CD pipelines, standardize project templates and tooling, and reduce friction in local development, testing, and releases.

Lead Backend Engineer - Piñata (Fintech / Credit Building, US)

Mar 2020 - Nov 2025 | Python, Django, PostgreSQL, AWS, RAG

- Designed and implemented core backend services and APIs for a rent-rewards and credit-building platform (reporting to Experian/TransUnion/Equifax).
- Led the migration from a single server to containerized ECS on AWS, improving scalability, resilience, and deployment speed.
- Built an AI-powered RAG service for customer success, enabling semantic search over support knowledge and cutting ticket resolution time.

Senior Backend Engineer - Kids Academy (EdTech, US)

Feb 2019 - Mar 2020 | Python, Django, DRF, PostgreSQL, Kafka, AWS

- Designed the authentication subsystem, REST APIs, and caching for high-traffic web and mobile clients.
- Led key performance and reliability improvements, including infrastructure upgrades on AWS.

Senior Backend Engineer - Artspace (E-commerce, EU)

Sep 2017 - Dec 2018 | Python, Django, MySQL, Magento

- Integrated Django services with Magento storefront and optimized critical code paths and queries for faster checkout and catalog operations.

Backend Engineer - Club Automation (SaaS, US)

Jun 2015 - May 2017 | Python, Django, PHP, MySQL

- Built backend modules (reporting, user profiles, ETL) for a club management SaaS platform and led migration to a new platform with minimal downtime.